

GLOBALMEDIC

Morocco Earthquake Response



THE CRISIS

Around 11pm local time on September 8, a 6.8 magnitude earthquake struck the High Atlas mountain range, 72 km southwest of Marrakech, Morocco, a city home to 840,000 people. The quake was followed by a 4.9 magnitude aftershock. This has been the biggest earthquake felt in the region. Extensive damage has been reported with buildings collapsed and critical infrastructure severely damaged. The death toll as of Monday was over 2,500. The death toll is expected to rise as rescue teams are unable to reach the most remote areas.

The Interior Ministry has stated that the majority of the damage occurred in rural areas, away from cities and towns. Entire villages near the epicenter have been flattened. In the town of Al-Haouz, located at the earthquake's epicenter, a collapsed house has trapped its residents beneath the rubble. At Amizmiz, a village close to the epicenter, rescuers worked tirelessly, using their hands to sift through the debris. The town has suffered severe damage, with fears of up to 2,000 casualties. Asni also faced immense devastation, with 90% of its houses destroyed. Furthermore, additional homes in towns near the epicenter either partially or completely collapsed.



THE RESPONSE

GlobalMedic has deployed our Rapid Response Team (RRT) with 4 AquaResponse3 Water Purification Systems to Morocco.

Following an earthquake of this magnitude, access to basic supplies becomes nearly impossible. This includes clean drinking water, with damage from the earthquake disrupting existing infrastructure such as water reservoirs. The AR3s are point-of-source water filtration devices that can provide clean drinking water to support over 2,000 people every day. These units will be installed at central locations like feeding centers and health clinics to ensure that the water being consumed at these sites is safe to drink.



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AID OFFERED

In response to the quake, GlobalMedic has offered the following forms of aid. We believe that we can make a difference and get the Right Aid to the Right People at the Right Time.

RescUAV Team: GlobalMedic has offered to do land/damage surveyance for the areas most heavily affected by the earthquake. This can help establish which roads/access points are up and running and help bring aid quicker.

Family Emergency Kits: The kit's primary component is a Rainfresh Household Water Purification Unit. It allows families to access clean water whenever and wherever they need, which is vital when you may have lost your home. These kits also include hygiene items, which are vital to maintaining good health, and a solar light which allow people in need a light source when power is unavailable. Our dedicated network of volunteers across the Greater Toronto Area pack these FEKs on a weekly basis to support our ongoing programs, and we are ready to get these into the country as soon as we are given the clearance to do so.

AquaTabs: AquaTabs are another extremely portable and quick solution to purify water, AquaTabs are compact and foil packaged water purification tablets are easy to use and easy to deploy for humanitarian aid.



THE RESPONSE

GlobalMedic's Rapid Response Team is also working with local partners to run a hot meal program. We have taken over a local cafe and are producing meals daily to provide to people affected by the earthquake. Every day we will be able to feed hundreds of people, ensuring they stay fed and healthy.

The team has delivered meals to displaced people living in makeshift accommodations as well as to a group of people in the hospital. They are continuing to look for vulnerable groups who will benefit from this assistance.

